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விவசாயத் திணைக்களம்
Department of Agriculture
(https://doa.gov.lk/)

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RICE IN SRI LANKA - RICE DISEASES

Narrow brown leaf spot

Causative agent

Fungus, *Sphaerulina oryzina*, (*Cercospora janseana*)

Plant parts and life stages affected

Leaf blades, leaf sheaths, pedicels and glumes

Severity of the disease varies in from year to year and is more severe as rice plants approach maturity.

Severity might also vary based on level of varietal susceptibility. This disease may and cause severe leaf necrosis, some premature ripening, yield reduction and lodging.

Symptoms

Typical lesions on leaves and upper leaf sheath are light to dark brown, linear, and progress parallel to the vein. They are usually 2–10 mm long and 1–1.5 mm wide.

Lesions on the leaves of highly susceptible varieties may enlarge and connect together, forming brown linear necrotic regions.

On glumes, lesions are usually shorter but can be wider than those on the leaves. Brown lesions are also found on pedicels.

The disease also causes discoloration on the leaf sheath, referred to as “net blotch” because of the netlike pattern of brown and light brown to yellow areas.

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Disease Management

Within the crop season

Application of urea in recommended dosages or application of urea based (../rrdi_fertilizerrecomendation) on leaf colour chart (../rrdi_div_soilscience_leafcolorchart).

If the crop is infected, following management options should be applied for the next season

Application of organic fertilizer to improve soil

Use of certified seed paddy free from the disease

Weed management (../rrdi_riceweeds)

Addition of burnt paddy husk (250 kg per acre) to the soil during land preparation.

Abstain addition of disease infected straw.

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